CURRICULUM RETRIEVAL STANDARD • 40 RECALL CHECKPOINTS

WORLD WAR II & THE HOME FRONT

MASTER KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL & ASSESSMENT COMPANION



Primary Archival Record: A London police sergeant checks the luggage label of a young evacuee at a railway station before departure, September 1939 (IWM).

Pupil Name: ..... **Class / Teacher:** ..... **Target Score:** ___ / 40

RETRIEVAL PRACTICE GUIDE **Attempt 1 (Solo):** Complete from memory in blue or black ink. Peer-mark in green pen using Page 4. • **Attempt 2 (Spaced):** Re-test unmastered checkpoints after 48 hours.

10-ENQUIRY KNOWLEDGE TRACKING LEDGER

TARGET: 40/40 MASTERY STANDARD

ENQ	HISTORICAL ENQUIRY FOCUS	PAGE REF	ATT 1 SCORE	ATT 2 SCORE	PARENT / TEACHER SIGN
01	**1. Outbreak 1939 & Home Front Mobilisation** Chamberlain's Broadcast • 38 Million Gas Masks • Blackout Drills	p. 2 • Q1–4	___ / 4	___ / 4	
02	**2. Operation Pied Piper & British Evacuation** Operation Pied Piper • Railway Luggage Labels • Billeting Officers	p. 2 • Q5–8	___ / 4	___ / 4	
03	**3. Vera's Journey & The Kindertransport** Kristallnacht (1938) • 10,000 Refugee Children • One Small Suitcase	p. 2 • Q9–12	___ / 4	___ / 4	
04	**4. The Blitz & Air Raid Shelters** 57 Nights of the Blitz • Anderson Garden Shelters • Tube Station Platforms	p. 2 • Q13–16	___ / 4	___ / 4	
05	**5. Blackout & ARP Wardens** Air Raid Precautions • 'Put That Light Out!' • Wailing Warning Sirens	p. 2 • Q17–20	___ / 4	___ / 4	
06	**6. Dig for Victory & Food Rationing** Atlantic U-Boat Blockade • The Ration Book • 'Dig for Victory' Gardens	p. 3 • Q21–24	___ / 4	___ / 4	
07	**7. Women at War & The Land Army** The Women's Land Army • Aircraft Assembly Lines • Breaking Gender Barriers	p. 3 • Q25–28	___ / 4	___ / 4	
08	**8. Pre-War Everyday Life & Rights Lost** Pre-War Jewish Life • Nuremberg Anti-Jewish Laws • Rights & Freedom Stripped	p. 3 • Q29–32	___ / 4	___ / 4	
09	**9. Bletchley Park & Codebreakers** The Enigma Cipher • Alan Turing's Bombe • Top-Secret Women of Station X	p. 3 • Q33–36	___ / 4	___ / 4	
10	**10. Rescuers, VE Day & Remembrance** Sir Nicholas Winton • Upstanders vs Bystanders • VE Day Street Celebrations	p. 3 • Q37–40	___ / 4	___ / 4	

Greater Depth: 36–40 / 40 Secure recall from long-term memory. **Expected Standard: 30–35 / 40** Solid understanding of wartime events. **Focused Review: ≤ 29 / 40** Review answers on Page 4.

1. TOTAL MOBILISATION
State control of civilian life, mass evacuation, blackout regulations, and food rationing.

2. CIVILIAN RESILIENCE
Anderson & Morrison shelters, ARP wardens, volunteer services, and enduring the Blitz.

3. INDUSTRIAL LABOUR
Women's Land Army ('Land Girls'), aircraft assembly lines, timber felling, and radar.

4. MORAL COURAGE
Nicholas Winton, the Kindertransport rescue, Bletchley codebreakers, and VE Day.

Part 1: The Outbreak, Evacuation, Kindertransport, The Blitz & Blackout — 20 Marks Available

ENQUIRY 01 — 1. Outbreak 1939 & Home Front Mobilisation

Score: ___ / 4

BRONZE 1. On what date did Prime Minister Neville Chamberlain announce that Britain was at war with Germany? [3 September 1939 / 11 November 1918]

SILVER 2. How many million civilian gas masks in cardboard boxes did the British government distribute in 1939?

SILVER 3. Why did volunteer ARP wardens enforce the blackout so strictly across British cities?

Because...

GOLD 4. How did carrying a gas mask change the daily school routine for British children?

This meant that...

ENQUIRY 02 — 2. Operation Pied Piper & British Evacuation

Score: ___ / 4

BRONZE 5. What official code name was given to the government's evacuation plan in September 1939? [Operation Pied Piper / Operation Dynamo]

SILVER 6. Why did authorities attach cardboard luggage labels directly onto children's coats?

So that...

SILVER 7. What was the official title of the local person responsible for finding foster homes for arriving evacuees?

GOLD 8. Why was evacuation both an exciting adventure and a heartbreaking separation for families?

Because...

ENQUIRY 03 — 3. Vera's Journey & The Kindertransport

Score: ___ / 4

BRONZE 9. Following which violent event in November 1938 did Britain agree to accept child refugees? [The November Pogrom (Kristallnacht) / The Blitz]

SILVER 10. Approximately how many predominantly Jewish refugee children were rescued on the Kindertransport?

SILVER 11. How many suitcases was each child permitted to pack when boarding the rescue train?

GOLD 12. Why did children like 9-year-old Vera Schaufeld wear a numbered identity card around their neck?

So that...

ENQUIRY 04 — 4. The Blitz & Air Raid Shelters

Score: ___ / 4

BRONZE 13. For how many consecutive nights was the city of London bombed during the Blitz in 1940? [57 consecutive nights / 7 consecutive nights]

SILVER 14. Name the garden air raid shelter made of curved corrugated steel covered with soil.

SILVER 15. Which indoor steel-cage shelter was designed to be built inside a room and double as a dining table?

GOLD 16. Where did over 150,000 London civilians choose to sleep each night to escape the bombing?

ENQUIRY 05 — 5. Blackout & ARP Wardens

Score: ___ / 4

BRONZE 17. What does the abbreviation "ARP" stand for in Second World War Britain? [Air Raid Precautions / Armed Royal Patrol]

SILVER 18. What warning phrase did ARP wardens shout when spotting a chink of light from a window?

SILVER 19. What did town councils paint white on streets and trees to help pedestrians walk in the dark?

GOLD 20. What sound warned that an enemy air raid was approaching, and what sound signalled the danger had passed?

KEY TERM VAULT (PART 1) Blackout • Operation Pied Piper • Billeting Officer • Kindertransport • Anderson Shelter • ARP Warden

Part 2: Rationing, Women's Work, Pre-War Rights, Codebreaking & VE Day — 20 Marks Available

ENQUIRY 06 — 6. Dig for Victory & Food Rationing

Score: ___ / 4

BRONZE **21.** Why did Britain introduce food rationing in January 1940? [German U-boats sank merchant cargo ships / Britain ran out of money]

SILVER **22.** What was the official document containing tear-out coupons that every citizen had to carry to buy food?

SILVER **23.** What nationwide campaign urged families to turn flowerbeds and parks into vegetable allotments?

GOLD **24.** Why was throwing away leftover food made a criminal offence punishable by fines during wartime?

Because...

ENQUIRY 07 — 7. Women at War & The Land Army

Score: ___ / 4

BRONZE **25.** What popular nickname was given to the 80,000 volunteers who joined the Women's Land Army? ["Land Girls" / "Wren Cadets"]

SILVER **26.** Name the specialized branch of the Women's Land Army who worked in forestry felling timber.

SILVER **27.** Name two vital roles women performed in wartime Britain outside of agricultural farming.

GOLD **28.** How did wartime service permanently alter women's position in British society?

It proved that...

ENQUIRY 08 — 8. Pre-War Everyday Life & Rights Lost

Score: ___ / 4

BRONZE **29.** Approximately how many Jewish people lived across the cities and towns of Europe before 1939? [Over 9 million / Under 50,000]

SILVER **30.** What traditional cardboard cone filled with sweets did German children carry on their first school day?

SILVER **31.** In what year were Jewish pupils completely banned from attending state schools in Germany?

GOLD **32.** How did discriminatory laws systematically strip away ordinary childhood joys between 1933 and 1939?

This meant that...

ENQUIRY 09 — 9. Bletchley Park & Codebreakers

Score: ___ / 4

BRONZE **33.** What was the name of the German electro-mechanical cipher machine used to scramble secret orders? [The Enigma machine / The Telegraph]

SILVER **34.** Which Buckinghamshire country estate served as Britain's top-secret codebreaking headquarters?

SILVER **35.** Name the brilliant mathematician who designed the "Bombe" machines to crack Enigma codes.

GOLD **36.** What percentage of the Bletchley Park workforce were women, and how long was their work kept secret?

ENQUIRY 10 — 10. Rescuers, VE Day & Remembrance

Score: ___ / 4

BRONZE **37.** Who was the 29-year-old London stockbroker who organized rescue trains saving 669 Czech children? [Nicholas Winton / Winston Churchill]

SILVER **38.** What is the definition of an "upstander" in historical studies?

SILVER **39.** What does "VE Day" stand for, and on what exact date was it celebrated across Britain in 1945?

GOLD **40.** Why is it vital that we continue to remember the courage and sacrifices of the Second World War generation?

To ensure that...

KEY TERM VAULT (PART 2) Ration Book • Dig for Victory • Women's Land Army • Kristallnacht • Enigma Machine • Upstander

Award 1 mark per correct historical fact. Pupils use green pen for peer assessment. **Total: 40 Marks**

Enquiry 01: Outbreak & Gas Masks — Q1–4

Q1: 3 September 1939 (at 11:15am) (Chamberlain broadcast from 10 Downing Street after Hitler ignored Britain's ultimatum to withdraw from Poland.)

Q2: 38 million gas masks (Fearing poison gas bombs remembered from the First World War, the government issued gas masks to every citizen.)

Q3: To prevent German bomber pilots from seeing streetlights or illuminated landmarks at night (Every window had to be covered with heavy black curtains so enemy bombers flying in darkness could not navigate.)

Q4: Children carried the cardboard box on their shoulder everywhere and practiced wearing respirators in regular drills (Pupils could not enter school or board buses without their box, practicing reading and writing while wearing rubber masks.)

Enquiry 02: The Evacuation Experience — Q5–8

Q5: Operation Pied Piper (In four days, 1.5 million schoolchildren, teachers, and mothers with babies were evacuated to rural reception areas.)

Q6: So billeting officers and volunteers could immediately identify bewildered children at busy railway stations (Labels recorded each child's name, home address, school, and destination station to keep classes and families organized.)

Q7: The Billeting Officer (Billeting officers inspected village cottages and assigned children to foster families, often in local village halls.)

Q8: Children discovered green fields and farm animals, but suffered deep homesickness separated from parents (Many city children had never seen cows or orchards, but missed their mothers and fathers with only letters to stay in touch.)

Enquiry 03: The Kindertransport Rescue — Q9–12

Q9: The November Pogrom (Kristallnacht) (After widespread violent Nazi attacks against Jewish homes and synagogues, Britain permitted unaccompanied child refugees.)

Q10: Nearly 10,000 children (approx. 9,354) (Rescue trains brought children from Germany, Austria, and Czechoslovakia to the Netherlands and by ferry to Harwich.)

Q11: Only one small suitcase (Nazi authorities strictly limited children to one bag with clothes and keepsakes; no money or valuables were allowed.)

Q12: To allow British volunteers and foster families to identify the correct child upon arrival in London (Most children spoke only German or Czech; their numbered neck tags matched records held at Liverpool Street Station.)

Enquiry 04: The Blitz & Shelters — Q13–16

Q13: 57 consecutive nights (Between September 1940 and May 1941, German bombers attacked London and industrial ports to crush civilian morale.)

Q14: The Anderson shelter (Over 3 million Anderson shelters were distributed free to low-income families to bury in back gardens.)

Q15: The Morrison shelter (Designed by Herbert Morrison, this steel cage protected families in homes without gardens from falling debris.)

Q16: On Underground tube station platforms (Civilians camped along deep tube platforms where dozens of feet of earth protected them from explosive bomb blasts.)

Enquiry 05: Blackout & ARP Wardens — Q17–20

Q17: Air Raid Precautions (ARP wardens were civilian volunteers who patrolled streets, directed people to shelters, and gave first aid.)

Q18: "Put that light out!" (Wardens patrolled streets on foot and bicycle checking for light leaks that could guide enemy bombers.)

Q19: Curbs, lampposts, tree trunks, and car bumpers (Because streetlights and normal car headlights were banned, white paint prevented accidents in total darkness.)

Q20: A rising and falling wailing siren (warning), followed by a continuous single-pitch tone (All Clear) (Sirens were mounted on police stations and town halls to give people enough time to enter shelters.)

Enquiry 06: Rationing & Dig for Victory — Q21–24

Q21: German U-boats sank merchant cargo ships in the Atlantic, causing dangerous food shortages (Britain imported 55 million tonnes of food yearly; rationing guaranteed equal, fair shares for every civilian.)

Q22: The Ration Book (Coupons were registered with local shopkeepers who stamped or clipped them when buying meat, butter, and sugar.)

Q23: "Dig for Victory" (The government urged families to grow potatoes and cabbages, producing over 3 million tonnes of domestic food.)

Q24: Because waste squandered supplies that Merchant Navy sailors had risked their lives to bring across the ocean (Wasting food was treated as helping the enemy; kitchen scraps were collected in pig swill bins to feed livestock.)

Enquiry 07: Women at War — Q25–28

Q25: "Land Girls" (Land Girls worked 50-hour weeks milking cows, ploughing fields, driving tractors, and harvesting food across Britain.)

Q26: The "Lumber Jills" (Women's Timber Corps) (Over 6,000 women operated heavy crosscut saws and worked in sawmills to produce timber for pit props and construction.)

Q27: Assembling aircraft in factories, driving ambulances, operating radar, or codebreaking at Bletchley Park (Women entered heavy industry, engineering, and the auxiliary armed services (ATS, WAAF, WRNS) in record numbers.)

Q28: It proved women could master skilled, demanding jobs equally with men, accelerating the move toward equality (Earning independent wages and running vital national infrastructure challenged outdated domestic stereotypes.)

Enquiry 08: Pre-War Life & Lost Rights — Q29–32

Q29: Over 9 million Jewish people (Jewish families lived in 21 European countries, attending ordinary schools, playing sports, and running businesses.)

Q30: A Schultüte (school cone) (The Schultüte celebrated entering school and was cherished by German children of all backgrounds before Nazi rule.)

Q31: November 1938 (Following the November Pogrom, Nazi decrees expelled all Jewish children from state schools into segregation.)

Q32: Jewish children were banned from sports clubs, swimming pools, public parks, riding bicycles, and owning pets (Step-by-step exclusion isolated Jewish children from friends and public life long before deportations began.)

Enquiry 09: Bletchley Park Codebreakers — Q33–36

Q33: The Enigma machine (Enigma used rotating wheels and a plugboard to scramble text into billions of mathematical code combinations.)

Q34: Bletchley Park (Station X) (Over 10,000 codebreakers, mathematicians, and service personnel worked in wooden huts intercepting enemy radio signals.)

Q35: Alan Turing (Turing and his team designed electromechanical Bombe machines that tested rotor positions in minutes.)

Q36: About 75% were women, and their work was kept secret for over 30 years (until the 1970s) (Women operated complex Bombe machines and decoded messages, strictly obeying the Official Secrets Act.)

Enquiry 010: Rescuers, VE Day & Legacy — Q37–40

Q37: Nicholas Winton (later Sir Nicholas Winton) (Winton cancelled a Swiss holiday in December 1938, opened an office in Prague, and arranged British foster homes.)

Q38: A person who takes active moral action to help or defend others in danger rather than remaining a bystander (Upstanders like Winton, Trevor Chadwick, and volunteer foster parents actively stepped forward to rescue innocent children.)

Q39: Victory in Europe Day, celebrated on 8 May 1945 (Following Germany's surrender, a national holiday was declared with joyful street parties and community feasts.)

Q40: To honour those who defended freedom, protect democracy, and learn from past atrocities to prevent prejudice (Remembrance ensures younger generations understand that freedom and human dignity must be protected.)

KEY STAGE 2 HISTORICAL VOCABULARY & CONCEPTUAL ANCHOR VAULT

ZERO TOKENISTIC DIRT • DEPARTMENT VERIFIED KEY

ARP (Air Raid Precautions): Civilian volunteers who patrolled darkened streets, enforced blackout rules, and directed families to safety.

Kindertransport: British rescue mission that transported nearly 10,000 unaccompanied refugee children to safety from Nazi Europe.

Anderson Shelter: Arched corrugated steel shelter assembled and buried in private gardens to protect against bomb blasts and debris.

Morrison Shelter: Indoor steel cage erected inside living rooms to shelter families without gardens, designed to double as a table.

Food Rationing: Fair-shares distribution system using coupon books to guarantee essential food after German U-boats sank merchant shipping.

Dig for Victory: Mass government campaign urging families to transform flowerbeds, lawns, and public parks into vegetable allotments.

Enigma Machine: Complex electro-mechanical cipher device used by the German military, decrypted by codebreakers at Bletchley Park.

Upstander: An individual who takes conscious, courageous action to defend and rescue others facing danger or persecution.

DEPARTMENT VERIFIED MARKING STANDARD • GREEN PEN REVISION STANDARD

PUPILS VERIFY IN GREEN PEN • SPACED RETEST AFTER 48H